

You can't access your D drive from Windows 98. There are a few third-party utilities that will allow you to do this, but these are not recommended. You will either have to boot into Windows XP to view your data on the D drive, or convert your D drive to the FAT32 format.

Internal and external conflict

Q. I download e-mail from my server using a pop puller, and forward it to the respective mailbox on my local exchange server.

Some users access their mailbox directly from the external mail server. Say my external mail server has the domain name abc.com, and the internal domain name is xyz.com. If I create a new internal domain abc.com, and host my exchange server on it, would I be able to forward e-mail of non-existing e-mail accounts from the internal server to the external server?

Sanket Shah

A You can't have the same name assigned to an internal as well as external mail server. There is an MX record associated with each domain name, which points to an IP address.

Password hacking

Q. Recently, one of my friends changed my Yahoo! password. When I tried to make my profile, I saw his ID in the alternate ID location. Now, each time I change my password, a message is sent to his account as well. Is he spying on me? How did he change the password? Tell me how to remove his ID from my profile.

Rahul Sarma

A Quite often, we inadvertently give out our passwords. You may have mentioned it in a chat to someone, and the chat was logged. Even more common is using a password that is easy to guess in less than 10 attempts. If you keep your mother's name as your password, you can be sure that almost all your friends can guess it!

Once a hacker logs into your

You can't have abc.com pointing to two different IP addresses. If your external server is abc.com, you need to have a sub-domain such as internal.abc.com for your internal server.

Kabhi on kabhi off

Q. I have an AMD K6 processor, 64 MB of SD RAM, a SiS 530 motherboard and a 10.2 GB Seagate hard disk. Recently, my PC started giving me error messages saying, "Fatal exception error in vxd... press any key to continue." When I press a key, the system comes back to normal, but only for a few seconds, and then I get the same message again.

I think it might be due to a virus, but I can't do anything, as my system only works for two to five minutes at a time.

I formatted, and tried re-installing Windows 98 SE, but the problem persisted. Finally, I installed Me, to no effect. I need to leave the system off for over five minutes to be able to use it.

V Shankar Iyer

A Since the problem exists even after re-installing the OS, it looks like you have a hardware issue. You say that leaving the system off for a while seems to temporarily solve the problem. This indicates a cooling problem. Check

your cabinet's fans. Make sure all of them are running.

The next suspect is RAM. Try and get a friend's RAM chip (make sure it's compatible with your system), and check stability using that. It could just as well be a bad hard drive or motherboard chip, so check these in turn.

Startup woes

Q. Often, when I boot up my computer, it hangs. If I press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del], I find a few additional entries that are not present when the computer is running. These are: scanregw, rnaap, smc and dbhelp. I can't see them in msconfig either. I want to disable these programs permanently. How do I do it?

Shirish

A rnaap is notorious for causing your type of problem. Uninstall and re-install Dial-up Networking, and if the problem persists, get your modem checked.

If the modem hangs when rnaap is initialising it, your system is likely to hang as well.

What's my voltage?

Q. How do I check the voltages of an ATX power supply. My power supply outputs about 4.5 volts at PS_ON, 5.2 at SB and 0.8 at PG. Please help me check the correct voltages of a power supply before connecting it to my motherboard.

Nasiruddin

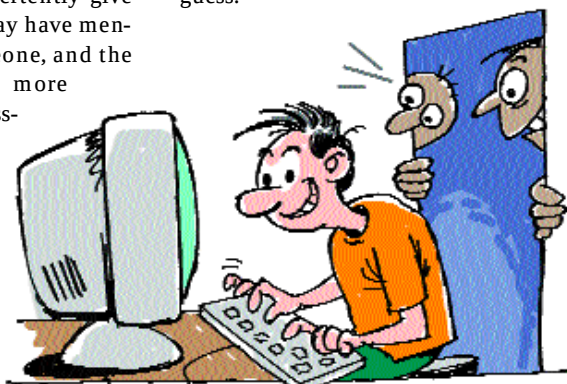
A The SB (purple wire) voltage should be 5 V. In the PS_ON state, red and white should read +5 V and -5 V respectively. Yellow and blue should have +12 V and -12 V respectively. Finally, orange should read +3.3 V, and black is the common wire.

XP tyranny

Q. I have a Pentium 4 2.8 GHz PC running Windows 2000 and Fedora core Linux. Recently, I installed Windows XP Professional. Ever since then, I can't boot into Linux. When I start my PC, it gives me an option between Windows 2000 or Windows XP, but no Linux or DOS option. How do I get it back?

Amit.

A Boot your PC with the Linux CD. Type 'linux rescue' at the boot prompt, and press [Enter]. Once you reach the command prompt, type 'chroot /mnt/sysimage', and press [Enter]. Here



Mahesh Benkar